

Worksheet 103 · Skills S3.2 · Analysing non-fictional texts

Questions on the text — your scaffold

One routine for every factual text. Fill in the gaps while we work on the Baxter text (book p. 230).

0 Know the task — the operator tells you what to do

I Comprehension	describe, outline, sum up	What does the text say?
II Analysis	analyse, examine, explain	How does it say it — and why?
III Evaluation	comment, discuss, assess	What do you think — and why?

1 Step 1 · Preparation

- Read the questions first, mark the operators.
- Skim: headline, lead, first and last paragraph.
- Read the whole text, mark key words.
- Purpose: text type, source, date, target group.
- Understand: 3–6 words per section in the margin.

Baxter, Helsinki's huge VR gig ...

Topic	_____
Text type	_____
Target group	_____
Purpose	_____

Connect: How does the target group explain the way Baxter writes?

2 Step 2 · Writing

2a Introductory sentence (first answer only)

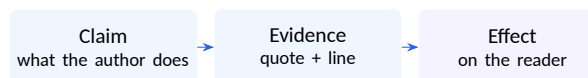
In the [text type] "[title]", published in [source] in [date], [author] [reporting verb] [topic].

2b Comprehension (I)

- only what is asked
- own words + line references
- present tense, no opinion

Our extra rule:

2c Analysis (II)



Thesis → one paragraph per aspect → conclusion

Our model paragraph (Baxter: respect for Helsinki's achievements) — mark C, E, E:

3 From device to effect — collect your own examples

Name the device and what it does in this text. A list of devices without effect earns little.

Device	Quote (line)	Effect on the reader
personal anecdote	_____	_____
expert quotes	_____	_____
short sentence	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

4 Step 3 · Editing and checking

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ I did exactly what the operator asks. | ☐ present tense, no contractions |
| ☐ Every statement has a line reference. | ☐ linking words show my line of thought |
| ☐ Quotes are exact and marked "...". | ☐ precise verbs instead of says |
| ☐ My opinion only where asked (III). | ☐ no repetition |

5 Language you need**Reporting verbs**

states · claims · argues · points out · emphasises · criticises · warns

Linking words

furthermore · however · consequently · for instance · all in all

Quoting

(I. 5) · (II. 5–7) · paraphrase: (cf. I. 5) · omissions [...]

My phrase bank: three phrases I want to use in my next answer

Effect phrases

... emphasises / underlines ... · ... creates the impression that ... · ... makes the reader feel ...

Tone

neutral · enthusiastic · sceptical · ironic · emotive · urgent

Online: step-by-step course, more phrases and the writing coach: edu-mrh.de → Englisch → Klasse 13 → Questions on the Text